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Education and training

- 2026 – present: **Assistant Professor** (University of Murcia).
 - June-July 2026: **Visitor scholar** at UC Berkeley (Supervisor: Dr. Mariam Aly).
- 2025: **Postdoctoral research fellow** at CIMCYC (University of Granada). Advisor: Dr. Javier Ortiz-Tudela. Project: [CONNECTS](#)
- 2020-2024: **Ph.D. Experimental Psychology** (cum Laude, international mention). Thesis title: Selection, Maintenance, and Removal of Working Memory Contents: A Behavioral and Electrophysiological Approach. Advisors: Prof. Guillermo Campoy and Prof. Luis J. Fuentes.
 - March-May 2024: **Visitor scholar** at Leibniz Research Centre for Working Environment and Human Factors in Dortmund (Supervisor: Prof. Michael Nitsche).
 - May-July 2022: **Visitor scholar** at the Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam (Supervisor: Prof. Christian N.L. Olivers).
- 2019-2020: **M.S. Behavioral and Cognitive Neuroscience**. University of Granada, Spain (Average grade: 9.58/10).
- 2015-2019: **B.A. Psychology**. University of Murcia, Spain (Bachelor's Degree Extraordinary Award).

Research (** Open data. † Preregistered)

Publications:

- ** Campoy, G., ... **Tortajada, M.** ... & Fuentes, L. J. (2026). The Deese/Roediger–McDermott (DRM) illusion in short-term memory: Opposite effects of retention interval on true and false recognition. *Memory and Cognition*. <https://doi.org/10.3758/s13421-026-01881-7>
- ** † **Tortajada, M.**, Rodríguez-Larios, J., Martínez-Pérez, V., Palmero, L. B., Melero, L. F., & Campoy, G. (2026). Endogenous theta as a function of task load and working memory capacity: revisiting the role of slower frequencies in theta-gamma coupling. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience*. <https://doi.org/10.1162/JOCN.a.2594> (Preprint: https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/u8cxe_v1)
- ** † Franco-Martínez, A., Rey-Sáez, R., ... **Tortajada, M.** ... & Vadillo, M. A. (2026). Replicating the unconscious working memory effect: a multisite Registered Report. *Neuroscience of Consciousness*, 2026(1), niaf046. <https://doi.org/10.1093/nc/niaf046>

- ** **Tortajada, M.**, Martínez-Pérez, V., Palmero, L.B., Fuentes, L. J., & Campoy, G. (2025). Distinguishing between temporary and permanent removal in verbal working memory. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition*. <https://doi.org/10.1037/xlm0001481>
- ** † Sandoval-Lentisco, A., **Tortajada, M.**, López-Nicolás, R., López-López, J. A., Wagenmakers, E. J., Sánchez-Meca, J., & Hardwicke, T. E. (2025). Preregistration of psychology meta-analyses: A cross-sectional study of prevalence and practice. *Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science* (Preprint: <https://osf.io/preprints/metaarxiv/627a4>)
- ** **Tortajada, M.**, Fahrenfort, J. J., Sandoval-Lentisco, A., Martínez-Pérez, V., Palmero, L. B., Castillo, A., Fuentes, L. J., Campoy, G., & Olivers, C. N. L. (2024). Decoding load or selection in visuospatial working memory? *Psychophysiology*, 00, e14636. <https://doi.org/10.1111/psyp.14636>
- ** Sandoval-Lentisco, A. López-Nicolás, R., **Tortajada, M.**, López-López, J.A., Sánchez-Meca, J. (2024). Transparency in Cognitive Training Meta-analyses: A Meta-Review. *Neuropsychology Review*, 1-18. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11065-024-09638-2>
- Palmero, L. B., Martínez-Pérez, V., **Tortajada, M.**, Campoy, G., & Fuentes, L. J. (2024). Testing the modulation of self-related automatic and others-related controlled processing by chronotype and time-of-day. *Consciousness and Cognition*, 118, 103633. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.concog.2023.103633>
- ** Palmero, L. B., **Tortajada, M.**, Martínez-Pérez, V., Sandoval-Lentisco, A., Campoy, G., & Fuentes, L. J. (2024). Circadian modulation of the time course of automatic and controlled semantic processing. *Chronobiology International*, 1-15. <https://doi.org/10.1080/07420528.2024.2312806>
- ** Martínez-Pérez, V., Sandoval-Lentisco, A., **Tortajada, M.**, Palmero, L. B., Campoy, G., & Fuentes, L. J. (2024). Self-prioritization effect in the attentional blink paradigm: Attention-based or familiarity-based effect? *Consciousness and Cognition*, 117, 103607. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.concog.2023.103607>
- ** Sandoval-Lentisco, A., **Tortajada, M.**, Palmero, L. B., Campoy, G., Fuentes, L. J., & Martínez-Pérez, V. (2024). Propiedades psicométricas de la adaptación española de la Clance Impostor Phenomenon Scale (S-CIPS). *Anales de Psicología/Annals of Psychology*, 40(1), 38-43. <https://doi.org/10.6018/analesps.537361>
- Martínez-Pérez, V., Andreu, A., Sandoval-Lentisco, A., **Tortajada, M.**, Palmero, L. B., Castillo, A., ... & Fuentes, L. J. (2023). Vigilance decrement and mind-wandering in sustained attention tasks: Two sides of the same coin? *Frontiers in neuroscience*, 17, 1122406. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fnins.2023.1122406>
- Martínez-Pérez, V., **Tortajada, M.**, Palmero, L. B., Campoy, G., & Fuentes, L. J. (2022). Effects of transcranial alternating current stimulation over right-DLPFC on vigilance tasks depend on the arousal level. *Scientific Reports*, 12(1), 547. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-021-04607-8>
- ** Luna, F. G.*, **Tortajada, M.***, Martín-Arévalo, E., Botta, F., & Lupiáñez, J. (2022). A vigilance decrement comes along with an executive control decrement: Testing the resource-control theory. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, 29(5), 1831-1843. <https://doi.org/10.3758/s13423-022-02089-x> *These authors contributed equally
- Palmero, L. B., Martínez-Pérez, V., **Tortajada, M.**, Campoy, G., & Fuentes, L. J. (2022). Mid-luteal phase progesterone effects on vigilance tasks are modulated by women's chronotype. *Psychoneuroendocrinology*, 140, 105722.
- ** Martínez-Pérez, V., Baños, D., Andreu, A., **Tortajada, M.**, Palmero, L. B., Campoy, G., & Fuentes, L. J. (2021). Propensity to intentional and unintentional mind-wandering differs in arousal and executive vigilance tasks. *PLoS one*, 16(10), e0258734.

Teaching

- Teaching several courses in the Psychology bachelor degree: **Motivation and Emotion** (2025/26), **Fundamentals of Psycholinguistics** (2025/26), **Attention and Executive Functions** (2020/21, 2021/22 and 2022/23), **Memory** (2020/21).

- **6 Undergraduate final degree thesis supervision** (2 with honors, 1 awarded as best Undergraduate Thesis Project by the *COP-RM*).
- **Coordinator** of the **teaching innovation project** (Attention and Executive Functions, 2021/22), and **collaborator** since 2021 in the innovation teaching group: *AppLab - Desarrollo de aplicaciones web y móviles para la realización de prácticas de laboratorio y otras actividades docentes*.

Scientific divulgation and transference

- Interview for Canal Sur TV program Conciencia: *CONNECTS, la paradoja del pensamiento*
- Participation in high school visit to CIMCYC: “¿De qué hablamos cuando hablamos de atención?” (04/04/2025)
- Sandoval-Lentisco, A., **Tortajada, M.**, Martínez-Pérez, V., & López-Nicolás, R. (2024). Una rata generada por IA se cuela en una revista de alto impacto o, de nuevo, las limitaciones del Factor de Impacto de una revista para evaluar la calidad de la investigación científica. *Ciencia Cognitiva*, 18:4, 14-16. <https://www.cienciacognitiva.org/?p=2402>
- Martínez-Pérez, V., Sandoval-Lentisco, A., Campoy, G., Palmero, L. B., Fuentes, L., & **Tortajada, M.** (2024) Desmitificando el éxito: El síndrome del impostor y por qué no es del todo malo experimentarlo. *The Conversation*. <https://theconversation.com/desmitificando-el-exito-el-sindrome-del-impostor-y-por-que-no-es-del-todo-malo-experimentarlo-224772>

Contributions in Congresses (representative contributions)

- Poster “Out of Place, Out of Mind? Examining the Impact of Contextual Congruency on Object Representation” by Tortajada, M., and Ortiz-Tudela, J. (ICON 2025)
- Poster “Testing the influence of participants’ baseline and task load as factors that modulate the effectiveness of theta tACS during working memory maintenance” by Tortajada, M., Martínez-Pérez, V., Palmero, L. B., Roy, S. Melero, L. F., & Campoy, G. (Neuromodulation Conference 2024)
- Poster “Tracking Working Memory Load Or Selection With Multivariate Pattern Analysis From Electroencephalographic Data” by Tortajada, M., Fahrenfort, J. J., Sandoval-Lentisco, A., Martínez-Pérez, V., Palmero, L. B., Melero, L. F., Campoy, G. & Olivers, C. N. L. (ESCOPE 2023).
- Poster “Tracking the Time Course of the Removal of Information from Working Memory Using Electrophysiology” by Tortajada, M., Fahrenfort, J. J., Sandoval-Lentisco, A., Martínez-Pérez, V., Palmero, L. B., Melero, L. F., Campoy, G. & Olivers, C. N. L. (Psychonomic Society Meeting 2022).
- Oral communication “Removing information from working memory temporarily or permanently.” by M. Tortajada, V. Martínez-Pérez, L. B. Palmero, A. Sandoval-Lentisco, L. J. Fuentes y G. Campoy (SEPNECA 2021).
- Oral comunicacion “The vigilance decrement comes along executive control decrement: testing the resources-control hypothesis” Tortajada, M., Luna, F. G., Martín-Arévalo, E., Botta, F., & Lupiáñez, J. (SEPEX 2021).

Organizational activities

- Co-organizer of the **ReproducibiliTea journal club** at the University of Murcia (2023-Present) (Twitter/X: @ReproTeaUM).
- Teacher representative to the Faculty of Psychology Board during the 2022/23 and 2023/24 academic years.

Awards and Grants

- **Mobility grant 2026**, from the *Moving Minds* program
- **Juan de la Cierva** Postdoctoral Fellowship 2024 (rejected for Assistant Prof. Position).
- **Mobility grant 2022**, funded by the Ministry of Universities
- **Mobility grant 2024**, funded by the *Escuela Internacional de Doctorado de la Universidad de Murcia*
- **AIIDI 2020 conference grant** as one of the best novel contributions.
- **FPU doctoral grant** (Four-year national grant awarded by the Spanish Ministry of Science, Innovation and Universities, 2020)
- **Bachelor's Degree Extraordinary Award** in Psychology (2019) at UMU
- **Collaboration grant** in the Department of Basic Psychology and Methodology under the supervision of Guillermo Campoy (2018/2019)

Additional education

- Attendance to courses of the Bachelor in **Data Science and Engineering** from the University of Murcia, 1st semester 2023: Linear Algebra, Introduction to Programming with **Python**, Discrete Mathematics
- Course: Data analysis and reproducible research with **R** (University of Murcia, 2022)
- Course: Ethics and integrity in research and **good scientific practices** (University of Murcia, 2020)
- Course: Complete **neural signal processing** and analysis: Zero to hero (Mike X Cohen, Udemy)
- Course: Virtual ERP Boot Camp: **Introduction to ERPs** (Steve Luck, <https://courses.erpinfo.org/courses/Intro-to-ERPs>).
- Course: International doctoral summer school 2020. **Multivariate pattern analyses** of EEG data: theory and practice (University of Granada)
- Course: Introduction to Programming with **MATLAB** (Coursera)
- **C1 English level**, *Cambridge*.
- **B1 French level**, *Escuela Oficial de Idiomas (EOI)*.
- **Student intern in the Department of Basic Psychology and Methodology** with Professor Guillermo Campoy during the academic year 2016-2017, at the University of Murcia.
- **Student intern in the Department of Basic Psychology and Methodology** with Professor Julio Sánchez Meca during the academic year 2015-2016, at the University of Murcia.